

Introduction to the
SUBJECT CLASSIFICATION MANUAL

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Foreword

The following survey is designed to help all users of the new UNDRO Subject Classification Manual by stating its purpose, defining its type, listing and explaining some of its unique features, and describing its layout, scope and system. A sample of codification analysis is included.

The major considerations in the selection of this system were, among others, based on the "Conclusions and Recommendations" contained in the AMS Report: "Management and Manpower Utilization in the United Nations Office at Geneva" (1969, 1971).

1 August 1977

Purpose

The purpose of this Manual is to facilitate the classification of all UNDRO codifiable communications (letters, memoranda, cables, referral sheets and, when appropriate, minutes of meetings, resolutions, and reports in document form) according to subject in a logical and readily referable system.

Definition of Type

This Manual is a subject manual.

A few major subject categories have been evolved. The headings and themes under each major subject are grouped and classified according to the inter-relationship of the subjects.

Major Characteristics

The major characteristics of this logically structured subject Manual are:

(a) Exclusiveness of breakdown of themes

The Manual is divided into a small number of major series, each of which is exclusive of the others, and all inclusive of the theme pertaining to it. In turn, the same principle is applied to the breakdown of the themes within each of the series. All further breakdowns are treated similarly, thus avoiding duplication and overlapping of subjects.

A search for a particular subject is therefore made through a process of elimination, without encumbering the memory and with maximum speed.

(b) Sources subordinated to subjects

As classification is made on a strictly subject basis, sources are classified under particular subjects, and cannot be classified parallel to subjects. Once a subject is broken down by source, it should only be broken down further by source, but a source may not be broken down by subject. Therefore, correspondence will be classified according to its subject and not to the source it emanates from or pertains to.

(c) Independence of organizational structure of UNDRO

As the themes are arranged by subject, the Manual does not reflect the organizational structure of UNDRO but only the subjects contained in its correspondence, thus making the Manual independent of any future changes in the Office.

(d) Organic approach for future expansion

In order to ensure that future development and expansion of UNDRO's activities could, as they occur, be smoothly and harmoniously integrated into the plan, the organic structure approach was used in establishing the Manual. As this Manual was created

at a time when UNDRO had already existed for 5 years, it was deemed desirable to base the Manual on the existing correspondence and the already manifested activities of UNDRO. Therefore, the actual correspondence was analysed and the derived themes were grouped in a logical manner into major categories, into which they fitted naturally, rather than forcing the themes into a preconceived mould. The process of grouping and regrouping was repeated at various levels until the final main series emerged as a natural consequence; pari passu the minor subject groups and themes were enlarged in order to accommodate possible future expansion at all levels.

Major Attributes

In order to facilitate the use of the Manual and maximise the benefits derived from it, it was considered important that the Manual should have, inter alia, the following attributes:

(a) Usability

The Manual was constructed in a manner that would make it readily understood and easily used by both codifiers and departments.

(b) Surveyability

The layout and sequence of themes was designed to show the overall scheme and the relationship of the various components at a glance.

(c) Language

The language of the Manual is simple. Bearing in mind the varied linguistic backgrounds of its potential users, it was considered desirable to avoid not only ambiguous phrases, but terms which may be similar or even identical in some languages, yet have, in fact, different meanings. On the other hand, apt phrases from other languages were on occasion translated and introduced into the Manual.

(d) Uniformity

All descriptions, definitions, file notations and titles are uniform in wording and printing and are placed in accordance with their relationship and place in the system.

(e) Definitions and Titles

Definitions are as brief and concise as possible. Titles indicate the essence or main points of the correspondence to which they pertain.

(f) Self-Indexing

The Manual is constructed in a way that makes it self-indexing by subject.

Some Technical Features

Certain technical features were especially devised for this Manual, in order to enhance its value and save time and labour for its users:

(a) Index Aids and Guides

Each series is preceded by a table listing the main themes and sub-themes (to the second and third breakdown). This page is commonly called: "Summary of Series' Content".

Various label tabs, to indicate the series, major numerical breakdowns and "lists", are attached to the appropriate sections.

(b) Page Layout

1) Main series titles

In the top left hand corner of every page, the title of the main series is listed, with every subject breakdown indented under it leading directly to the subject in the text of the page.

2) Significance of indentation

Subject breakdowns are indented under the subject to which they pertain. Each successive breakdown and inter-relationship of the sub-themes is indented to an extent indicative of the relationship to the overall plan.

3) Case files

Case files are indented to commence right off the centre of the page in order to distinguish them clearly from the subject breakdown. For the sake of clarity, whenever case files are more than five, an additional page is added to the left hand side of the Manual.

4) Numbers

The numbers indicating the file code are listed on the extreme right of the page.

5) Date of issue

The date of issue of each page is marked in the lower corner of the page. Additions and amendments to the Manual are communicated to the users.

(c) Notes and Definitions

1) Notes in text

Notes and definitions are placed at the bottom of the page; only in cases where they are an integral part of the subject are they written in the body of the text.

2) Appendices

Where it is deemed necessary to outline background information or special procedural practices, an appendix is added at the end of the series.

(d) Lists

1) Notes referring to lists

Lists are not enumerated in the body of the text; a note indicates the existence of a list and its subject matter.

2) Placement of lists

Lists are placed on the left hand side of the Manual, in numerical order as referred to in the body of the text.

3) List titles

Lists are uniformly designed; each list is headed by its title and carries its subject number, as well as full information as to its place in the Manual.

Numbering System

The numbering system assigned is a modified decimal system. The major considerations in the selection of this system were:

(a) Basic Numbers

1) The system is based on recognized fundamental rules.

2) It enables the exercise of permanent control by:

I) limiting the number of major breakdowns, thus checking tendencies to uncontrollable expansion.

II) it imposes discipline and careful thought when opening new subject files.

III) it enforces uniformity and consistency throughout the system.

3) It is expandable as well as pliable, as it enables almost limitless opportunities for further developments of the number, i.e. the subject breakdown. This elasticity is greatly increased by adding lettered prefixes and suffixes.

4) The numbers reflect the relationship between the subjects and indicate their relative position in the series breakdown.

5) The length of the number and its composition indicate the type of subject and how major or detailed it is.

6) Abbreviated letter prefixes are assigned to the main series as a mnemonic device. This device also enables addition of complementary new major fields of activity to the Manual.

7) The digits written after the letter prefix appear in a group of three (INF 100, INF 110, INF 111); beyond that break, the zeros are not written, (FIN 321/2, FIN 321/21, FIN 321/211) thus limiting the zero endings to main subjects for easy identification, and at the same time avoiding unnecessarily long numbers.

(b) Case File Numbers

The nature of case files, i.e. the application of a subject to a special type or source, is reflected by their numerical designation, which is composed of the basic subject number and the case symbol.

1) Source Case Files (by name, country, etc.)

Source case files are designated by the name, or its abbreviation: e.g. PER 313/1 SMITH, ADM 213 USA

2) Type Case Files (by type of subject or type of source)

I) Simple Case

The type case files are designated by numbers placed in brackets to distinguish them from subject numbers: INF 133/1(1)

Case files are numbered consecutively in order not to limit their number under a subject: (12) is the 12th case file under the subject designated as: CSM 430.

II) Complex Case

To indicate that the case is broken down further by case, a dash is placed between the numbers: DPR 121(1-2) is the second case breakdown of case file DPR 121(1). In order not to encumber the number, a bracket does not contain more than three breakdowns:
DPR 121(1-2-2)

(c) Special Suffixes

Where it is deemed necessary to distinguish the files as "Confidential", "Policy and Procedure", or "General", the suffixes "CONF", "P+P", or "GEN" are added to the numbers. "GEN" files are marked so only when "P+P" files already exist.

Description of Manual

The Manual is composed of the following seven series:

- | | |
|------------------------|--|
| Organization | - This series contains the structure and responsibilities of UNDRO, its organizational structure, relationship and co-ordination with various sources and protocol |
| Administrative Matters | - The subjects in this series deal with services provided by or for the Office of the Co-ordinator such as: communications, publications, management of premises, procurement of equipment and supplies. |
| Financial Matters | - The subject matter of this series includes: Accounting, auditing, budgeting, income and expenditure, custody of resources and remuneration payments. |

- | | |
|--|---|
| Personnel Matters | - All matters relating to personnel, including duties and privileges, movement and welfare, are covered by this series. |
| Conferences, Seminars and Meetings | - The subjects in this series deal with organization, invitations to, and participation in UNDRO's joint or outside conferences, seminars and meetings. |
| Information | - The series contains dissemination of information, production of information material, relations with various media and public relations activities. |
| Disaster Preparedness, Prevention and Relief | - Technical assistance, research, projects, studies, reports and information; pre-disaster planning, monitoring of creeping disasters, relief operations, rehabilitation and reconstruction programmes are the subjects of this series. |

Process of Codification Illustrated

Bearing in mind the major principles of subject classification, the actual codification of correspondence (i.e., identifying it with the correct subject and assigning the code number) according to the new Manual is a very speedy process. As any subject can be found in only one of the series, the main themes of the relevant series alone have to be perused. The determination of the final subject is arrived at by a successive selection of the one relevant heading; thus at each level, the major themes only have to be perused, eliminating the need to examine lengthily the lists of titles.

The following example will elucidate this process:

An individual sends a letter enclosing a monetary donation. Out of the seven main series, the most logical series to select in this case is "Finance". A glance at the second breakdown of the financial series reveals the third theme, designated "Contributions" (FIN 300), as the most likely theme to harbour the subject in question. On further examination it is immediately seen that this theme is broken down into two major sub-themes, namely,

- 1) "Contributions towards UNDRO's Regular Budget" FIN 310, and
- 2) "Contributions Outside the Regular Budget" FIN 320. It is obvious that our sample subject is concerned with the latter sub-theme. In turn, FIN 320 is sub-divided into several themes according to the type of extra-budgetary income; even the most cursory perusal would immediately lead to the sub-theme FIN 322, which is "Donations from Individuals". In turn this theme is further sub-divided, FIN 322 () which for our sample correspondence is the correct subject.

By following a logical process of elimination and aided by technical devices designated to facilitate surveyability, the correct subject is found within a few seconds, as can be seen in the following diagrammatic illustration.

Diagrammatic Illustration of Codification Sample

FINANCIAL MATTERS	FIN 000
Financial Control	FIN 100
Budgeting	FIN 200
Contributions	FIN 300
Special Handling and Custody of Resources	FIN 400
Salaries and Allowances	FIN 500
Contributions towards UNDRO's Regular Budget	FIN 310
Contributions Outside the Regular Budget	FIN 320
Trust Fund for the Strengthening of UNDRO	FIN 321
Donations from Individuals	FIN 322

case file FIN 322()

Appendix A details these seven series to their third breakdown, while Appendix B illustrates the general layout of a typical page of the Manual and the manner in which the various breakdowns are grouped.

SUMMARY

ORG Organization

Constitution, Status and Terms of Reference of UNDRO	ORG 100
Collection of Miscellaneous Documentation which Led to the Establishment of a UN Disaster Relief Office	ORG 110
General Assembly and ECOSOC Resolutions Related to UNDRO's Establishment, Responsibilities and Work Programme	ORG 120
Organizational Structure, Relationships and Co-ordination	ORG 200
UNDRO's Structure and Work Plan	ORG 210
Co-ordination, Planning and Agreements	ORG 220
Establishment and Development of Relationships	ORG 230
Reports to Organizational Bodies	ORG 240
International Days, Years and Decades	ORG 250
Protocol Matters	ORG 300
Guidance and Information on Protocol Matters	ORG 310
Invitations to and Participation in Ceremonies and Functions ...	ORG 320
Honours, Decorations, Prizes and Awards	ORG 330
Messages	ORG 340

ADM Administration

Planning and Provision of Administrative Services	ADM 100
Consultative Committee on Administrative Questions	ADM 110
Administrative Rules and Instructions	ADM 120
Communications and Records	ADM 200
Communications	ADM 210
Correspondence Procedures	ADM 220
Records Maintenance and Control	ADM 230
Documents, Publications and Reference Library	ADM 300
Documents and Publications	ADM 310
Reference Library	ADM 320
Travel and Transportation	ADM 400
Travel	ADM 410
Transportation	ADM 420
Management of Premises	ADM 500
Allocation and Utilisation of Office Space, Storage Areas and Utility Services	ADM 510
Maintenance, Alteration and Improvement of Premises	ADM 520
Transfer of Services to Other Locations	ADM 530
Security and Safety Arrangements for the Protection of Personnel, Premises and Property	ADM 540

Equipment and Supplies	ADM 600
Procurement of Equipment and Supplies	ADM 610
Property Control	ADM 620
Contracts, Insurance and Claims	ADM 700
Contracts Related to the Use of Outside Expertise and Professional Services	ADM 710

FIN Financial Matters

Financial Control	FIN 100
General	FIN 110
Accounts and Accounting	FIN 120
Auditing and Inspection	FIN 130
Budgeting	FIN 200
General	FIN 210
Budget Planning and Execution	FIN 220
Administration of the Budget	FIN 230
Contributions	FIN 300
Contributions towards UNDRO's Regular Budget	FIN 310
Contributions Outside the Regular Budget	FIN 320
Special Handling and Custody of Resources	FIN 400
Imprest Cash Funds	FIN 410
Banking and Postal Arrangements	FIN 420
Currency and Rates of Exchange	FIN 430
Investment	FIN 440
Salaries and Allowances	FIN 500
Salaries	FIN 510
Allowances	FIN 520

PER Personnel Matters

General	PER 100
Co-ordination of Practices with UN Organs and Specialized Agencies	PER 110
Staff Listing and Personnel Statistics	PER 120
Duties, Obligations and Privileges	PER 200
Staff Rules and Regulations	PER 210
Standards of Conduct, Commitments and Financial Responsibilities of International Civil Servants	PER 220
Status of International Officials	PER 230
Hours of Work and Holidays	PER 240
Outside Activities	PER 250

Appointment, Movement and Training of Personnel	PER 300
Recruitment, Movement and Training of Personnel	PER 310
Movement of Personnel	PER 320
Training of Personnel	PER 330
Leave, Social Security and Welfare	PER 400
Annual, Special and Sick Leave	PER 410
Social Security	PER 420
Staff Welfare, Benefits and Activities	PER 430
Staff Relations and Appeals	PER 500
Bodies Representing the Staff	PER 510
Staff Complaints	PER 520
Disciplinary Procedures and Actions	PER 530
Appeals	PER 540

CSM Conferences, Seminars and Meetings

General	CSM 100
Calendar of Conferences	CSM 110
Meetings not Attended by UNDRO	CSM 120
Conferences and Meetings Organized by UNDRO	CSM 200
Joint Conferences and Meetings	CSM 300
Invitations to, and Participation in, Outside Conferences and Meetings	CSM 400
Conferences and Meetings of UN Organs and Offices	CSM 410
Conferences and Meetings of Specialized Agencies	CSM 420
National and International Conferences and Meetings	CSM 430

INF Information

Dissemination of Information	INF 100
General	INF 110
Press and Publications	INF 120
Radio and Visual	INF 130
Public Relations Activities	INF 200
Invitation and Participation of UNDRO's Officials in Outside Activities	INF 210
Public Interest Correspondence	INF 220

DPR Disaster Preparedness, Prevention and Pre-disaster Planning, Disaster Relief, Post-Disaster Rehabilitation and Reconstruction

General, Disaster Preparedness and Prevention	DPR 100
Technical Co-operation	DPR 110
Research, Studies, Reports and Information	DPR 120
Pre-disaster Planning, Monitoring of Creeping Disasters and Disaster Relief Operations	DPR 200
Pre-disaster Planning	DPR 210
Monitoring of Creeping Disasters and Disasters with Limited or No Involvement of UNDRO	DPR 220

Mobilization and Co-ordination of Emergency Relief	DPR 230
Rehabilitation and Reconstruction Programmes	DPR 240

Training of Personnel	DPR 250
Leave, Social Security and Welfare	DPR 260
Annual, Special and Sick Leave	DPR 270
Social Security	DPR 280
Staff Welfare, Benefits and Activities	DPR 290
Staff Relations and Appeals	DPR 300
Bodies Representing the Staff	DPR 310
Staff Complaints	DPR 320
Disciplinary Procedures and Actions	DPR 330
Appeals	DPR 340

General Conferences, Seminars and Meetings	GEN 100
General	GEN 110
Calendar of Conferences	GEN 120
Meetings not attended by UNHCR	GEN 130
Conferences and Meetings Organized by UNHCR	GEN 140
Joint Conferences and Meetings	GEN 150
Invitations to, and Participation in,	GEN 160
Outside Conferences and Meetings	GEN 170
Conferences and Meetings of UN Organs and Offices	GEN 180
Conferences and Meetings of Specialized Agencies	GEN 190
National and International Conferences and Meetings	GEN 200

Public Information	INF 100
Dissemination of Information	INF 110
General	INF 120
Press and Publications	INF 130
Radio and Visual	INF 140
Public Relations Activities	INF 150
Invitation and Participation of UNHCR's	INF 160
Officials in Outside Activities	INF 170
Public Interest Correspondence	INF 180

Disaster Preparedness, Prevention and Pre-disaster Planning,	DPR 200
Disaster Relief, Post-Disaster Rehabilitation and Reconstruction	DPR 210
General, Disaster Preparedness and Prevention	DPR 220
Technical Co-operation	DPR 230
Research, Studies, Reports and Information	DPR 240
Pre-disaster Planning, Monitoring of Ongoing Disasters	DPR 250
Pre-disaster Planning	DPR 260
Monitoring of Ongoing Disasters and Disasters with Limited	DPR 270
or No Involvement of UNHCR	DPR 280

	ORG 000
<u>Constitution, Status and Terms of Reference of UNDRO</u>	ORG 100
<u>Collection of Miscellaneous Documentation which Led to the Establishment of a UN Disaster Relief Office</u>	ORG 110
<u>General Assembly and ECOSOC Resolutions Related to UNDRO's Establishment, Responsibilities and Work Programme*</u>	ORG 120
<u>Organizational Structure, Relationship and Co-ordination</u>	ORG 200
<u>UNDRO's Structure and Work Plan</u>	ORG 210
UNDRO's Structure and Responsibilities	ORG 211
UNDRO's Work Plan	ORG 212
case files:	
Work Plan 1972, 1973	ORG 212(1)
Work Plan 1977-1979	ORG 212(2)
Restructuring and Strengthening of UNDRO**	ORG 213
<u>Co-ordination, Planning and Agreements</u>	ORG 220
International Conventions and Agreements	ORG 221
case files: (by agreement)	
Agreements between Organizations and UNDRO	ORG 222
case files: (by organization)	
FAO - IAEA - ICEM - ILO - LRCS	
UNEP - UNICEF - UNIDO - WFP - WHO	
<u>Establishment and Development of Relationship</u>	ORG 230
Co-operation and Liaison***	ORG 231
UN Organs and Offices	ORG 231/1
case files (by organ and office)	
Specialized Agencies	ORG 231/2
case files: (by agency)	
Governments and Governmental Offices	ORG 231/3
case files: (by country)	
Inter-Governmental Organizations	ORG 231/4
case files: (by IGO)	
Non-Governmental Organizations	ORG 231/5
case files: (by NGO)	
Universities and Institutions	ORG 231/6
case files: (by country/institution)	
Individuals	ORG 231/7
case files:	

* Cross-referenced in subject-file.

** For correspondence concerning meetings of the "Technical Advisory Panel of Experts", see: Conferences, Seminars and Meetings, series CSM 200 ().

*** This series of files should be used only when: (a) there is not an appropriate subject file, or (b) the communication has to be cross-referenced in a large number of files.